MAKKAH ZIYARAT: 6

MASJID AL-SHAJARAH

Location

In the Al-Hujun district, opposite Masjid al-Jinn and approximately 190 meters from Jannat al-Mualla cemetery, about 1 to 1.5 kilometers north of Masjid al-Haram in Makkah, Saudi Arabia.

Timings

Open 24 hours for prayer; accessible to Muslim visitors throughout the year during prayer times.

About This Site

Masjid al-Shajarah, meaning "the Mosque of the Tree," stands as one of the most spiritually captivating sites in Makkah. Its name commemorates a remarkable miracle in which Prophet Muhammad ﷺ called upon a tree, and it responded by moving toward him, bearing witness to his prophethood before returning to its place. This extraordinary event, recorded in authentic hadith collections, serves as a powerful testament to the truth of Islam and the divine support granted to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ during times of rejection and hardship.

Located in the Al-Hujun district, directly opposite Masjid al-Jinn and near Jannat al-Mualla cemetery, this small mosque draws pilgrims seeking to connect with this lesser-known yet profound miracle from the life of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. The site reminds believers that all of Allah's creations, including trees and mountains, recognize and honor the truth of prophethood, even when human hearts remain stubborn in their denial.

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For pilgrims performing Hajj or Umrah, visiting Masjid al-Shajarah offers a moment of deep reflection on the power of faith, the miracles granted to Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, and the unwavering support of Allah for His chosen messenger. It is a place where the natural world itself bore witness to the truth of Islam, inviting visitors to contemplate the depth of divine signs and the certainty of prophethood.

Historical Significance

The Miracle of the Moving Tree

The most significant event associated with this site is the miracle of the tree that moved toward Prophet Muhammad ﷺ when he called upon it. According to authentic hadith narrations, this miracle occurred during a time when the Prophet ﷺ was facing intense opposition and rejection from the Quraysh and other tribes in Makkah. In response to their denial, he sought a sign from Allah to affirm his prophethood, and Allah granted him this remarkable miracle.

- The event is recorded in authentic hadith collections including Sunan al-Tirmidhi.
- The tree moved from its place and approached Prophet Muhammad ﷺ.
- This miracle affirmed the truth of Islam to those who witnessed it.

The Context of Rejection and the Need for a Sign

This miracle took place during a period of profound hardship for Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and the early Muslim community. The message of Islam was being rejected by many tribes, including the people of the Hajoon area. In the face of this denial, the Prophet ﷺ sought a clear sign from Allah to demonstrate the truth of his mission. The moving tree became that sign, a visible affirmation that even the natural world recognized and honored the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.

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- The miracle occurred during a time of intense opposition to Islam.
- The people of the Hajoon tribe had rejected the Prophet's ﷺ message.
- The tree's movement served as a divine response to this rejection.

The Hadith Narration and Its Authenticity

The miracle of the moving tree is narrated in several authentic hadith collections, including Sunan al-Tirmidhi, where it is reported by Anas ibn Malik (RA). The narration describes how the tree responded to the Prophet's ﷺ call, moved toward him, and then returned to its place after bearing witness. Scholars of hadith have authenticated this narration, and it stands as one of the well-known miracles granted to Prophet Muhammad ﷺ.

- The hadith is narrated by Anas ibn Malik (RA), a close companion.
- It is recorded in Sunan al-Tirmidhi and other recognized collections.
- Hadith scholars have authenticated the narration.

The Names and Identity of the Mosque

Over the centuries, this mosque has been known by several names, each reflecting a different aspect of its history. It is called Masjid al-Shajarah, meaning "the Mosque of the Tree," commemorating the miracle itself. It is also referred to as Masjid al-Shajarat al-Mashiyah, "the Mosque of the Walking Tree," emphasizing the tree's movement. These names preserve the layered history of the site and its connection to this extraordinary event.

- Masjid al-Shajarah means "the Mosque of the Tree."
- Masjid al-Shajarat al-Mashiyah means "the Mosque of the Walking Tree."
- Each name preserves a different dimension of the mosque's legacy.

The Mosque's Construction and Historical Development

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Historical sources indicate that the mosque was built on the traditionally identified location where the miracle occurred. Like many historical mosques in Makkah, it has undergone multiple phases of renovation and reconstruction over the centuries. Despite these changes, the site's identity as the place associated with the moving tree has remained constant, preserving the memory of this miracle for generations of pilgrims.

- The mosque was built on the traditionally identified location of the miracle.
- It has undergone multiple renovations and reconstructions over time.
- The mosque stands as a testament to the enduring memory of this event.

The Site Today

Physical Appearance Today

Masjid al-Shajarah is a small, well-maintained mosque with simple architecture. It is modest in size but designed to accommodate worshippers comfortably. The structure reflects respect for its historical significance without elaborate decoration.

Historical Remains and Structures

No original structures from the time of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ remain at this site. The current mosque is a later construction on the traditionally identified location where the miracle of the tree took place.

Modern Development and Surroundings

The area around Masjid al-Shajarah has developed significantly with Makkah's expansion. It is now located on a main road near Masjid al-Jinn and Jannat al-Mualla cemetery, surrounded by modern buildings and infrastructure, yet it remains a distinct landmark.

Access for Visitors

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Masjid al-Shajarah is freely accessible to Muslim visitors during prayer times. It is approximately a 15 to 20 minute walk from Masjid al-Haram or a short drive by taxi or car.

Why Pilgrims Still Visit

Pilgrims visit Masjid al-Shajarah to connect with the story of the moving tree and to reflect on the miracles granted to Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. This mosque stands as a unique reminder that all of Allah's creations, including trees, recognize and honor the truth of prophethood.

For many visitors, Masjid al-Shajarah becomes a place of spiritual curiosity and reflection. Standing where the tree once moved toward Prophet Muhammad ﷺ inspires a deeper appreciation for the divine signs granted to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and the certainty of his mission. It is a reminder that faith is not confined to human acknowledgment alone but is recognized by all of creation.

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the significance of Masjid al-Shajarah?

Masjid al-Shajarah commemorates the miracle where a tree moved toward Prophet Muhammad ﷺ when he called upon it, bearing witness to his prophethood, an event recorded in authentic hadith collections.

Where is Masjid al-Shajarah located in Makkah?

It is in the Al-Hujun district, opposite Masjid al-Jinn and approximately 190 meters from Jannat al-Mualla cemetery, about 1 to 1.5 kilometers north of Masjid al-Haram in Makkah, Saudi Arabia.

Can visitors pray at Masjid al-Shajarah today?

Yes, the mosque is open 24 hours for prayer and is accessible to Muslim visitors throughout the year during prayer times.

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